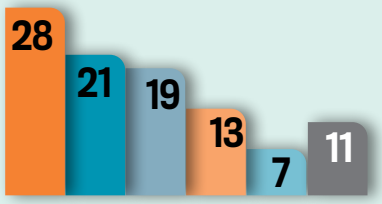
The call for change, ushering in people-centric reforms and schemes in various sectors, from education to agriculture, echoes loudly across India. But while the respondents of the India Today Mood of the Nation (MOTN) August 2024 poll welcome reforms, they remain cautious about certain changes, such as the three new criminal laws, and favour robust checks and balances. The spectre of paper leaks looms large, putting a question mark on the conduct of multiple recruitment and entrance exams. The MOTN poll reveals that the most widely held perception—28.2 per cent—is that the central government is primarily responsible for the paper leaks earlier this year, followed by the authorities tasked with conducting the tests (21.2 per cent). That the state governments are responsible is the view held by a significant 18.8 per cent of the respondents while 13.3 per cent believe the individuals involved in the process of paper preparation and distribution are culpable. Just 7.3 per cent suspect the role of organised gangs in question paper leaks.

What is disconcerting is that less than half of the respondents polled in any of the past eight MOTN polls feel that India has become safer for women, a sad reality only reinforced by the brutal rape and murder of a 31-year-old trainee doctor at the R.G. Kar Medical College and Hospital in Kolkata. Despite the fact that the poll was conducted before the incident triggered a national debate on women's safety, just 42.3 per cent thought India has become safer for women, a tad lower than the 43.1 per cent of the respondents in the Feb. 2024 poll. That another 37.9 per cent of the respondents feel India has become less safe for women while 15.7 per cent say it has remained the same testify to the challenges in ensuring gender sensitivity and justice.

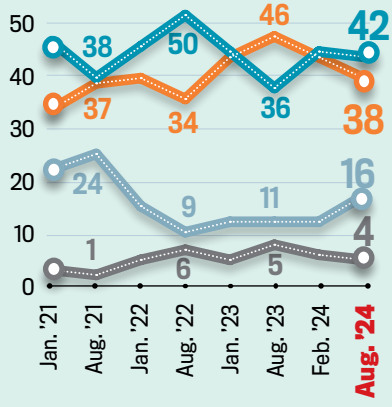
Q. Who do you think is primarily responsible for frequent paper leaks in examinations?

MOTN AUG. '24



Central government
Authorities responsible for conducting exams
State government
Individuals involved in the process of paper preparation and distribution
Organised gangs
DK/CS

Q. Has India become safer or less safe for women?

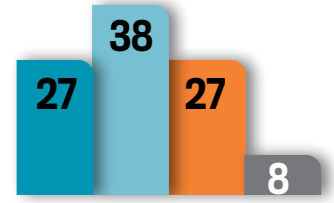


Become safer for women
Become less safe for women
Remained the same
DK/ CS

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say

Q. Do you think the Agnipath scheme for military recruitment should continue?

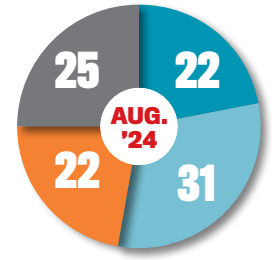
MOTN AUG. '24



Yes, it should continue without any change
Yes, but with some improvements
No, it should be discontinued
DK/ CS

A majority of the respondents want the Agnipath scheme to be either shelved or improved

Q. What's your view on the three new criminal laws?



It's an important reform
It's a good reform but needs more checks
The laws are dangerous as they give excess power to police and executive
DK/ CS

36%

of the respondents from the South, the highest across all regions, believe that the new criminal laws are dangerous as they give excess power to the police and the executive